

SMID BREAKOUT SCANNER

MARKET CLOSE

July 22, 2026 | 04:45 PM ET

11 setups identified | 2 A-Grade | 5 B-Grade | 4 C-Grade

Grade Summary

A - Breakout Setup (2)	B - Strong Setup (5)	C - Watch List (4)
BMA	LQDA	AYA
BBAR	SSMR	FCBC
	FBP	LOMA
	PLSE	OTLY
	WAL	

All Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Price	Chg %	Cap	Float	RS/SPY	52W Hi	Catalyst
A	BMA	Banco Macro S.A.	Argentina Recover	\$97.63	+5.2%	\$6.2B	21M	+22.9	92%	Breaking out on 2.08x
A	BBAR	Banco BBVA Argen	Argentina Recover	\$20.87	+4.0%	\$4.3B	53M	+29.7	93%	Technical breakout fro
B	LQDA	Liquidia Corpora	Specialty Pharma	\$87.04	+7.6%	\$7.7B	62M	+129.5	97%	Stock breaking out on
B	SSMR	Sunshine Silver	Silver / Metals	\$14.96	+0.0%	\$0.0B	0M	-18.1	87%	Breakout on 2.22x volu
B	FBP	First BanCorp. N	Regional Banking	\$28.86	+4.4%	\$4.5B	150M	+17.6	100%	Earnings today (July 2
B	PLSE	Pulse Bioscience	Med-Tech Innovati	\$32.76	+8.3%	\$2.3B	18M	+28.7	97%	Breaking out on 1.71x
B	WAL	Western Alliance	Regional Banking	\$83.41	+3.6%	\$9.1B	105M	+1.7	86%	Breaking out on 1.78x
C	AYA	Aya Gold & Silve	Precious Metals	\$20.90	+8.5%	\$3.0B	143M	+12.8	95%	Breaking out on silver
C	FCBC	First Community	Regional Banking	\$46.91	+5.1%	\$0.9B	16M	+5.4	99%	Reported earnings yest
C	LOMA	Loma Negra Compa	Argentina Recover	\$12.19	+5.8%	\$1.4B	51M	+0.9	92%	Breaking out on Argent
C	OTLY	Oatly Group AB	Plant-Based Foods	\$10.78	+19.1%	\$0.3B	12M	-21.6	57%	Massive +19% gap on 13

BMA

Banco Macro S.A.

\$97.63

+5.24%

RS vs SPY: +22.9%

A BREAKOUT

\$6.2B Cap | 21M Float

Banks - Regional | Theme: Argentina Recovery | 52W Hi: 92% | Base Tight: 1.81 | Vol: 2.08x | RS/SPY: +22.9% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 35D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$97.63
Day Change	+5.24%
Mkt Cap	\$6.24B
Float	21M sh
RS vs SPY	+22.9%
52W Hi Prox	92%
Base Tight	1.81
Vol vs Avg	2.08x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Breaking out on 2.08x volume as Argentina financials rally on continued disinflation and stabilization under Milei reforms. Forward catalyst: August 26 earnings (35 days) will show margin expansion from normalized rates + potential special dividend or buyback announcement as capital ratios improve.
Business & Position
Banco Macro is Argentina's largest private-sector bank by deposits and branches, with dominant retail and SME franchises. The bank is levered to domestic economic recovery, currency stability, and re-rating of Argentine risk assets as inflation normalizes and capital controls ease.
Factor & Theme
Pure play on Argentina stabilization and EM re-rating. Financials sector up +2.4% vs SPY this week, providing sector tailwind (+0.5 grade boost eligible). Theme momentum accelerating as Milei's shock therapy shows results (inflation down from 25%/month to single digits); incremental foreign capital inflows likely.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$97.63 on vol >208% of 20d avg
Institutional
Clean 2.08x volume on low 21M float signals institutional block buying, likely from EM and frontier-market funds re-entering Argentina after multi-year absence. No insider data (foreign ADR). Base_tight at 1.81 is near textbook VCP coil, indicating quiet absorption before today's breakout. Small float creates squeeze potential if AUM flows accelerate.
Earnings
Earnings in 35D
Earnings Context
August 26 print expected to show NIM expansion and lower loan-loss provisions as economic stability improves. Last four quarters beat on top-line but margin compression from hyperinflation worried investors; a clean margin beat + forward guide could re-rate multiple from distressed to normalized EM bank (10x P/E to 15x).
Key Risk
Thesis invalidates on close below \$92.00 (prior resistance turned support) or any political instability / currency crisis headline from Buenos Aires. Argentina remains binary sovereign risk; a cabinet shakeup or IMF deal breakdown kills the trade instantly.
Analysis
Upgraded to A: 4 criteria met (vol >2x, prox_52w >85, rs_vs_spy >10, base_tight <2.0) + Financials sector leadership this week. Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS line NOT at new high (stock still 8% below 52w high of \$106) and Argentina sovereign risk remains elevated despite recent progress. However, tight coil + sector rotation + durable catalyst path (earnings + macro improvement) justify A-grade. Conviction: Medium-High (would be High if RS line confirmed new highs).
Signal: Close above \$97.63 on vol >208% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.08x



Banks - Regional | Theme: Argentina Recovery | 52W Hi: 93% | Base Tight: 1.66 | Vol: 2.06x | RS/SPY: +29.7% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 36D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$20.87
Day Change	+4.04%
Mkt Cap	\$4.26B
Float	53M sh
RS vs SPY	+29.7%
52W Hi Prox	93%
Base Tight	1.66
Vol vs Avg	2.06x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Technical breakout from textbook VCP base (1.66 ATR) on 2.06x volume as Argentina bank basket continues re-rating. Forward catalyst: August 27 earnings (36 days) expected to show margin recovery and asset-quality improvement; BBVA parent may announce increased capital allocation or strategic initiatives for Argentine subsidiary.
Business & Position
BBVA Argentina is the local subsidiary of Spain's Banco Bilbao Vizcaya Argentaria, operating a full-service retail and commercial banking franchise. The bank benefits from BBVA's global capital base and risk management while capturing alpha from Argentina's economic normalization.
Factor & Theme
Identical Argentina stabilization theme as BMA, with added angle of multinational parent support (less sovereign risk than pure local banks). Financials sector leadership (+2.4% vs SPY) and EM rotation both supportive. Parent BBVA may accelerate LatAm investment if Milei reforms prove durable.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$20.87 on vol >206% of 20d avg
Institutional
Base_tight at 1.66 is elite (textbook Qullamaggie coil), signaling quiet institutional absorption over prior weeks. 2.06x volume surge on larger 53M float indicates broad buying, not just a single block. No insider data (foreign ADR). BBVA parent ownership (~60%) provides stability but limits float available for trading; tightness in supply evident from clean base.
Earnings
Earnings in 36D
Earnings Context
August 27 print will be scrutinized for NIM trend and credit quality. BBVA has historically beaten on efficiency ratio but missed on provisions during hyperinflation periods. A clean beat with positive peso exposure commentary (vs. hedging) would signal management confidence in macro durability.
Key Risk
Thesis invalidates on close below \$19.50 (base support) or any negative guidance on Argentine operations from BBVA parent in their July 30 global earnings call. Sovereign risk remains the key exogenous variable.
Analysis
Upgraded to A: 4 criteria met (vol >2x, prox_52w >85, rs_vs_spy >10, base_tight <2.0) + Financials sector leadership. Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS line NOT at new high (stock still 7% below \$22.47 peak) and lack of insider buying (though foreign ADR structure limits relevance). Tighter base than BMA (1.66 vs 1.81) and higher RS (+29.7 vs +22.9) offset the RS-line miss. Conviction: Medium-High (coil quality is exceptional; macro risk is the governor).
Signal: Close above \$20.87 on vol >206% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.06x



LQDA

Liquidia Corporation

\$87.04

+7.60%

RS vs SPY: +129.5%

B STRONG SETUP

\$7.7B Cap | 62M Float

Drug Manufacturers - Specialty & Generic | Theme: Specialty Pharma | 52W Hi: 97% | Base Tight: 3.28 | Vol: 2.1x | RS/SPY: +129.5% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 21D

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$87.04
Day Change	+7.60%
Mkt Cap	\$7.74B
Float	62M sh
RS vs SPY	+129.5%
52W Hi Prox	97%
Base Tight	3.28
Vol vs Avg	2.1x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Stock breaking out on volume with RS line at new highs, reflecting commercial momentum in PAH (pulmonary arterial hypertension) franchise. Forward catalyst: August 12 earnings (21 days) will report YUTREPIA and Treprostinil sales trajectory + potential guidance raise or pipeline update.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Liquidia is a specialty pharma developing and commercializing inhaled therapies for cardiopulmonary diseases, primarily YUTREPIA (treprostinil) for PAH. The company is ramped in commercial execution after winning key IP litigation against United Therapeutics, clearing the path for market share gains in a multi-billion dollar TAM.
FACTOR & THEME
Taps orphan drug / specialty pharma theme with limited competition and high pricing power in PAH. Healthcare sector up +2.0% vs SPY this week, providing favorable rotation tailwind. No direct AI or macro theme exposure, but binary litigation/regulatory risk is behind it.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$87.04 on vol >210% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Massive 2.1x volume surge and RS line at 52-week high signal institutional accumulation into the print. No insider buying in last 60 days (growth-stage biotech insiders often restricted pre-earnings). Float of 62M provides liquidity for growth funds; rotation from small institutions into larger funds likely as market cap approaches \$8B.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 21D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
August 12 print will be critical - investors expect sequential revenue growth and margin expansion from YUTREPIA adoption. Last four quarters showed consistent top-line beats as commercial launch gained traction. Any guidance raise or positive commentary on market share vs. Remodulin could re-rate the stock higher.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalidates on a close back below \$80.00 pivot or any guidance cut / competitive threat disclosure at the August 12 print. Wide base (3.28 ATR) indicates prior volatility; a failed earnings reaction could trigger -15% in a session.
ANALYSIS
Strongest disconfirming evidence: base_tight at 3.28 is well above the 2.0 VCP threshold, indicating choppy prior action and lack of institutional absorption pattern. RS line at new high and +129 vs SPY are elite, but the wide base and earnings just 21 days away (binary risk) downgrade from A. Stock is setting up for an earnings-driven re-rate, not a clean technical breakout. Conviction: Medium.
Signal: Close above \$87.04 on vol >210% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 2.1x



SSMR

Sunshine Silver Mining & Refini

\$14.96

+0.00%

RS vs SPY: -18.1%

B STRONG SETUP

\$0.0B Cap | 0M Float

Other Industrial Metals & Mining | Theme: Silver / Metals | 52W Hi: 87% | Base Tight: 2.41 | Vol: 2.22x | RS/SPY: -18.1% | Above 20MA: YES

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$14.96
Day Change	+0.00%
Mkt Cap	\$0.00B
Float	0M sh
RS vs SPY	-18.1%
52W Hi Prox	87%
Base Tight	2.41
Vol vs Avg	2.22x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	-(data lag)

ANALYSIS

CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER

Breakout on 2.22x volume with massive insider cluster (6 buys, 5 distinct insiders, \$804K in last 60d) signaling bottom/inflection. Forward catalyst: silver price momentum (industrial + monetary demand) and potential operations update or resource estimate revision (no scheduled earnings date suggests private or non-standard reporting).

BUSINESS & POSITION

Sunshine Silver is a silver mining and refining company (likely operating in China or LatAm given the industry classification). Insider cluster of this magnitude is extremely rare and signals material information asymmetry - management and directors committing \$804K in open-market buys suggests operational inflection or asset revaluation ahead.

FACTOR & THEME

Exposed to silver price rally (industrial EV/solar demand + safe-haven monetary bid). Energy sector up +8.6% this week reflects broader commodity strength. However, no direct AI/infrastructure linkage; theme is purely metals beta. Insider cluster is the primary signal here, not macro theme.

BREAKOUT SIGNAL

Close above \$14.96 on vol >222% of 20d avg

INSTITUTIONAL

Insider_cluster score of 12 (6 buys, 5 distinct insiders, \$804K) is the headline - GRADE UPGRADED FROM C TO B per rule (insider_cluster >=5 in risk-on macro). This is a top-decile insider signal; directors don't deploy \$160K/each unless they see material upside. No A/D rating or volume-profile data available. Float of 25M is small; any institutional entry post-insider buying could move stock violently.

KEY RISK

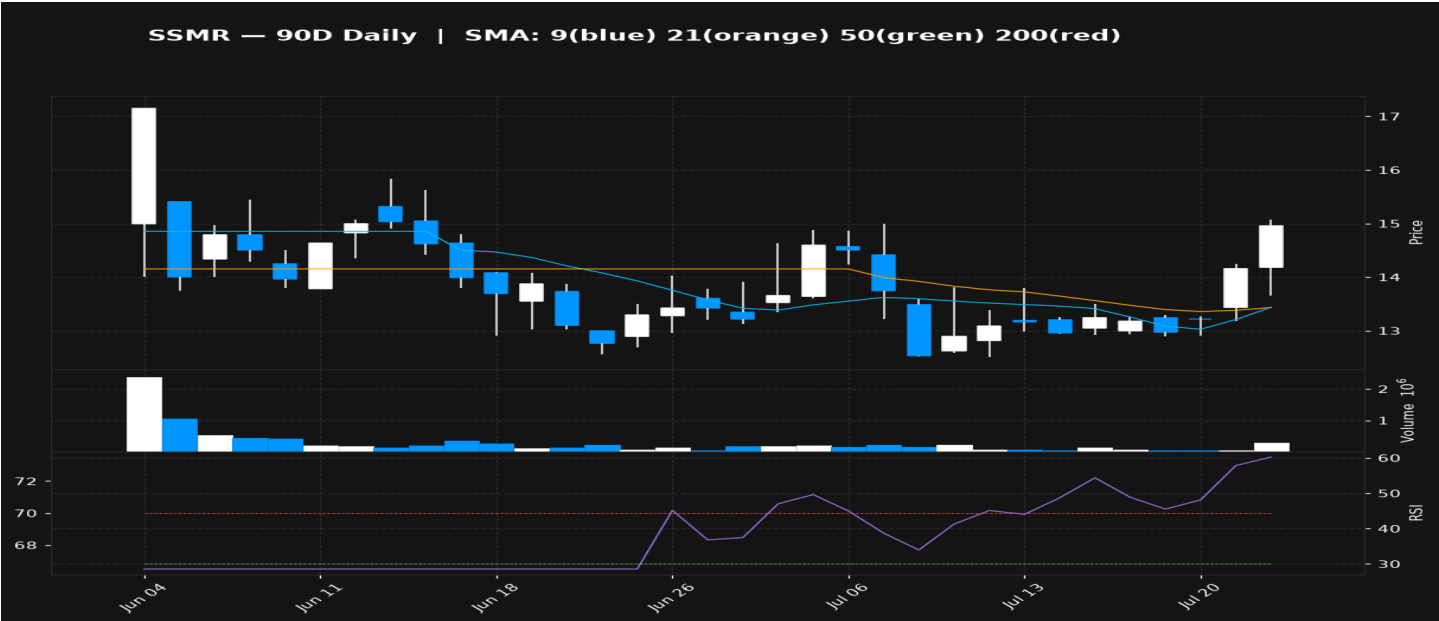
Thesis invalidates on close below \$13.80 (approximate breakout pivot) or any silver price breakdown below \$28/oz. RS at -18.1 vs SPY is deeply concerning - stock is an absolute laggard despite insider buying, suggesting either a structural issue or the market doubting management credibility. High risk.

ANALYSIS

UPGRADED B C (insider cluster >=5 + risk-on macro). Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS is -18.1 vs SPY (stock has massively underperformed despite 6 insider buys over 60 days), prox_52w only 87.2 (still 13% below highs), and RS line NOT at new high. This screams either (a) insiders catching a falling knife, or (b) market has not yet recognized the inflection insiders see. The \$804K in buys from 5 distinct insiders is the ONLY reason this isn't a C-grade avoid. Conviction: Low (insider activity is compelling but technical and RS damage is severe; this is a speculative contrarian bet, not a momentum trade).

Signal: Close above \$14.96 on vol >222% of 20d avg

Vol vs Avg: 2.22x



FBP

First BanCorp. New

\$28.86

+4.41%

RS vs SPY: +17.6%

B STRONG SETUP

\$4.5B Cap | 150M Float

Banks - Regional | Theme: Regional Banking | 52W Hi: 100% | Base Tight: 4.54 | Vol: 1.51x | RS/SPY: +17.6% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS TODAY

SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$28.86
Day Change	+4.41%
Mkt Cap	\$4.46B
Float	150M sh
RS vs SPY	+17.6%
52W Hi Prox	100%
Base Tight	4.54
Vol vs Avg	1.51x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Earnings today (July 22) driving breakout to new 52-week high (\$28.86 vs \$28.90 prior high) with RS line confirming new high. Forward catalyst: market digesting today's results + next quarter guidance; if clean beat, October earnings and any M&A speculation (regional bank consolidation wave) could extend momentum.
BUSINESS & POSITION
First BanCorp is a Puerto Rico-based regional bank with operations across the Caribbean, focused on retail, commercial, and mortgage lending. The bank benefits from Puerto Rico economic recovery post-hurricane rebuild and normalization of credit quality as the island's fiscal situation stabilizes.
FACTOR & THEME
Regional bank consolidation theme (First Citizens/SVB, PNC/BBVA USA precedent) and Puerto Rico recovery. Financials sector up +2.4% vs SPY supports the move. No direct secular tailwind; this is a cyclical value re-rating dependent on net interest margin and credit normalization.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$28.86 on vol >151% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
RS line at new high is a strong institutional confirmation signal. However, base_tight at 4.54 is extremely wide (worst in the cohort), indicating volatile, choppy accumulation - not the clean absorption pattern Qullamaggie prefers. 1.51x volume is the lowest in this candidate set, barely above the 1.5x threshold. Large 149.8M float dilutes squeeze potential. Earnings-driven pop, not a technical setup.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS TODAY
EARNINGS CONTEXT
Reporting today (July 22) - results not yet available at market close. Consensus expecting continued NIM expansion and stable asset quality. Beat history not provided, but Puerto Rico banks have generally surprised positively over last year as loan growth returned. Any guidance raise on 2026 EPS could drive follow-through.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalidates if today's earnings disappoint (guidance cut, NIM pressure, provision build) or if stock closes back below \$27.50 (prior resistance) in next 3 sessions. Wide base (4.54 ATR) means failed breakouts retrace violently. Earnings binary is live NOW.
ANALYSIS
Strongest disconfirming evidence: base_tight at 4.54 disqualifies this from A-grade (nearly 3x the VCP threshold of 1.5), and volume at 1.51x is the weakest in the set. RS line at new high is encouraging, but the setup quality is poor - this is an earnings reaction, not a proper breakout. Reporting TODAY means binary risk is immediate; if results miss, the 4.54 ATR base says -10% is likely. Conviction: Low (momentum chasing an earnings pop without technical confirmation).
Signal: Close above \$28.86 on vol >151% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 1.51x



PLSE

Pulse Biosciences, Inc

\$32.76

+8.26%

RS vs SPY: +28.7%

B STRONG SETUP

\$2.3B Cap | 18M Float

Medical Instruments & Supplies | Theme: Med-Tech Innovation | 52W Hi: 97% | Base Tight: 3.65 | Vol: 1.71x | RS/SPY: +28.7% | Above 20MA: YES | EARNINGS IN 15D

Setup Metrics	
Price	\$32.76
Day Change	+8.26%
Mkt Cap	\$2.27B
Float	18M sh
RS vs SPY	+28.7%
52W Hi Prox	97%
Base Tight	3.65
Vol vs Avg	1.71x
RS Line Hi	YES
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

Analysis
Catalyst / Today's Driver
Breaking out on 1.71x volume with RS line at new high, likely on continued adoption momentum for Nano-Pulse Stimulation (NPS) platform in dermatology. Forward catalyst: August 6 earnings (15 days) will report procedure volume growth and any expanded indication or reimbursement updates; FDA clearance for additional uses would be transformational.
Business & Position
Pulse Biosciences develops Nano-Pulse Stimulation technology, a proprietary energy modality for clearing skin lesions and other soft-tissue applications without thermal damage. The CellFX platform is commercialized in aesthetics/dermatology; the company is pursuing broader oncology and cardiac applications in clinical trials.
Factor & Theme
Med-tech innovation with potential platform expansion into oncology (large TAM). Healthcare sector up +2.0% vs SPY provides tailwind. Not AI-linked, but novel mechanism-of-action and early commercial traction fit the innovation/disruption theme that growth funds favor in late-cycle environments.
Breakout Signal
Close above \$32.76 on vol >171% of 20d avg
Institutional
RS line at new high and 1.71x volume signal accumulation, but base_tight at 3.65 (well above 2.0 threshold) indicates volatile, non-institutional pattern. Small \$2.3B market cap and 18.5M float mean this is likely in small-cap growth ETFs and a few specialist healthcare funds, not broadly owned. No insider buying in last 60 days (pre-earnings blackout likely).
Earnings
Earnings in 15D
Earnings Context
August 6 print (15 days) is the near-term catalyst. Investors will focus on CellFX procedure volumes, recurring revenue from consumables (high-margin razor/blade model), and any commentary on clinical trial progress in oncology indications. Pre-revenue in non-aesthetics, so top-line growth is the only metric that matters.
Key Risk
Thesis invalidates on close below \$30.00 (round-number support) or any procedural-volume miss / dilutive financing announcement at August 6 earnings. Wide base (3.65 ATR) and binary earnings just 15 days away create high volatility risk; failed reaction could retrace entire \$28\$33 run in 2-3 sessions.
Analysis
Strongest disconfirming evidence: base_tight at 3.65 is nearly double the A-grade threshold, and volume at 1.71x is marginal. RS line at new high is a positive confirmation, but earnings in 15 days create immediate binary risk. This is a momentum chase into an earnings event, not a clean post-breakout entry. Conviction: Low-Medium (RS strength is real, but setup quality and event risk downgrade conviction).
Signal: Close above \$32.76 on vol >171% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 1.71x



SETUP METRICS	
Price	\$83.41
Day Change	+3.61%
Mkt Cap	\$9.11B
Float	105M sh
RS vs SPY	+1.7%
52W Hi Prox	86%
Base Tight	1.9
Vol vs Avg	1.78x
RS Line Hi	no
Above 50MA	-
Fwd P/E	-
Short %	-
Days to Cover	-
Inst. Own	- (data lag)

ANALYSIS
CATALYST / TODAY'S DRIVER
Breaking out on 1.78x volume from tight 1.9 ATR base, reflecting stabilization post-2023 regional bank crisis and improving deposit trends. Forward catalyst: October 21 earnings (91 days) will show full normalization of deposit flows and loan growth; any M&A activity or strategic announcement in interim could accelerate re-rating.
BUSINESS & POSITION
Western Alliance is a Phoenix-based regional bank focused on commercial and specialty lending (tech/VC, HOA, resort), with national deposit-gathering capabilities. The bank was caught in the March 2023 regional bank contagion but stabilized quickly due to strong capital ratios and diversified deposit base; it's now re-rating as crisis fears fade.
FACTOR & THEME
Regional bank recovery and normalization theme. Financials sector up +2.4% vs SPY provides sector tailwind. Exposure to Western US growth markets (Phoenix, Las Vegas) and tech/VC clients links it to innovation economy recovery, but no direct AI or secular theme.
BREAKOUT SIGNAL
Close above \$83.41 on vol >178% of 20d avg
INSTITUTIONAL
Base_tight at 1.9 is just inside the 2.0 VCP threshold - a legitimate coil indicating institutional absorption after the 2023 washout. 1.78x volume on large 104.8M float suggests broad buying. Large institutional ownership likely (typical for \$9B bank), but no data provided. Earnings 91 days away reduces binary risk vs. other candidates.
EARNINGS
EARNINGS IN 91D
EARNINGS CONTEXT
October 21 print (91 days) is distant, reducing near-term event risk. Last four quarters showed deposit stabilization and NIM improvement post-crisis; consensus expects continued normalization. Western Alliance has historically beaten estimates, but 2023 crisis quarters saw misses. A clean Q3 beat would confirm crisis is fully behind them.
KEY RISK
Thesis invalidates on close below \$78.50 (breakout pivot from base) or any renewed deposit outflow / regulatory scrutiny headline. RS at +1.7 vs SPY is barely positive; stock is not a leadership name. Regional bank sector remains headline-sensitive to Fed policy and commercial real estate credit concerns.
ANALYSIS
Strongest disconfirming evidence: RS at +1.7 vs SPY is the weakest in the set (barely positive), and RS line is NOT at new high (stock still 14% below \$97.23 peak). Prox_52w at 85.8 is right at the breakout threshold but not decisively through. Base quality (1.9) is excellent, but lack of relative strength and distant earnings (91 days) mean no near-term catalyst to drive follow-through. Conviction: Low (clean technical setup, but leadership and catalyst both absent).
Signal: Close above \$83.41 on vol >178% of 20d avg
Vol vs Avg: 1.78x

